

c. 1946

The following is a faithful transcription of the typed original by the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.

Miss Mildred Maueal

45 Candler Ave. Detroit, Michigan,

My Dear Madam: M. M. M.: God bless you and yours.

I hope this finds your out-look brightening. I just read your letter of the 11th--pathetic indeed--and surely do sympathize with you. Perhaps I ought rather to congratulate you on the unusual experience you are of course inclined to learn/ and which the unbelieving world must look upon as a sad indication of failure.

But O: Why discouragement as long as we have a spark of faith left? What different view we get by exercising and by fostering the "triune virtue FAITH, HOPE, CHARITY! In the first place "life" here in this world is so short--comparatively so momentary--that in regard to its success or failure one is inclined to think: "...After all, what is the difference?"--"life" so short, that worldlings are so inclined to worship as the only LIFE--as everything worth.

How is it possible that man can be so shallow-minded and still be considered "rational"?

Your failure, yes, is an indication of weakness of some kind, somewhere. But if "The weak thing of this world hath God chosen to confound the strong....." as St. Paul so wonderfully assures us--and the history of religion abounds in examples and all creation says Amen--then why ever be discouraged: unless it be that our faith, more or less weakens?

Why dear sister, you ought to rather thank God for having given you such an opportunity to humble yourself and such a wonderful chance to foster humility--and by thanking Him ahead of time for whatever crosses He may deign to caress you with, CONFIDENCE in His wisdom. Confidence in God--the very soul of prayer--hardly comes to any poor sinner like we all are, without trials and humiliations, and your failure, though simple and possibly single, has no doubt been quite a little cross, at least for a "little soul" to carry. There is a little verse I am sure will prof you to keep in mind and ought help you foster confidence in God.